

Call Prep: Kate Bugakova - Techbar SW

Today, 10:30 AM CDT | 30 min | Teams

Organized by: David O'Hara | kate.bugakova@techbarsw.com

Who Is Techbar?

Boutique software engineering and staff augmentation firm. Small (under 100 employees). Madrid-area presence, Eastern European engineering talent base (Ukraine-origin DNA - Kate came from CHI Software). Core pitch: senior engineers embedded in your team in 48-72 hours, onboarded in 1-2 weeks.

Three service lines:

- Staff Augmentation - their devs, your management, your sprint cadence
- Dedicated Engineering Hub - stable team, long-term roadmap alignment
- Talent Transfer - they manage first, you hire them directly after a set period

Technical focus: AI/ML integration, cloud migration, legacy modernization, data infrastructure

Who Is Kate?

Role: Business Development at Techbar - front-door person, sources and owns partnerships

Background: Former Head/Director of Strategic Partnerships at CHI Software (large Ukrainian dev shop). Moved to Techbar - likely a newer or smaller venture with CHI alumni DNA.

Location: Greater Madrid area

Character: Active LinkedIn presence writing about BD and IT staffing trends. Attended London Tech Week, AI World Congress. She thinks commercially and writes publicly. She's a connector, not a technologist.

She is not a technical buyer. She's evaluating whether a referral, subcontracting, or co-sell relationship is worth building with Improving.

What She Probably Wants

Most likely play: she wants Improving to send her client referrals (clients who need staff aug), or she wants to position Techbar as a bench resource Improving could draw on. Less likely but possible: she has a client opportunity she can't staff and wants to co-deliver with Improving.

No prior relationship found in IES - treat as a first call.

Your Position

Improving doesn't white-label or resell third-party talent. Improving sells Improving consultants on Improving engagements. Be direct about this early so neither of you wastes time.

Realistic partnership plays:

1. Referral exchange - Improving sends overflow or non-core engagements her way; she refers clients who need more than staff aug
2. Co-sell into enterprise accounts - if she has an enterprise door Improving doesn't and vice versa

3. Sub-contractor bench - low probability given Improving's model, but worth understanding their quality bar

Agenda (30 min)

Time	Topic
0-5 min	Let her set the agenda - 'What were you hoping to explore today?'
5-15 min	Understand their client profile, industries, size, geographies
15-22 min	Be direct: here's how Improving's model works and what partnership actually looks like for us
22-28 min	If there's a fit angle, get specific: is there a deal or client in mind?
28-30 min	Next step or clean close

5 Questions / Talking Points

1. Open by letting her show her hand.

"Kate, what were you hoping to explore on this call?" Don't pitch Improving first - understand what she came in looking for.

2. Client profile and fit.

"Which industries and company sizes do you typically work with? What's the typical engagement look like - T&M, fixed scope, long-term retainer?" This tells you whether Improving clients would ever be Techbar clients.

3. Quality and bench reality.

"When you say senior engineers placed in 48-72 hours - what does senior mean to Techbar, and what's your bench looking like right now?" If this ever becomes a sub relationship, the quality bar matters.

4. The CHI Software connection.

"I see your background is at CHI Software - how does Techbar differentiate from that world?" Shows you did homework. Also clarifies whether this is a spinoff, rebrand, or independent entity.

5. Be direct about the Improving model.

"Here's how we typically work - we staff Improving consultants into client engagements. We don't generally white-label or resell external talent. So the most natural fit, if there is one, is probably a referral exchange or finding an enterprise account where we can both bring value. Does that match what you were thinking?"

Post-Call Action Items

☐ Decide: is there a partnership angle worth pursuing?

☐ If yes: loop in Alice to track follow-up cadence

☐ If no: send a clean close and log the contact

Notes
